University of the Incarnate Word
Office of Financial Assistance
2017-2018 Understanding Your Award

4301 Broadway, Box 308
San Antonio, TX 78209
Phone: (210) 829-6008
Fax: (210) 283-5053
finaid@uiwtx.edu
www.uiw.edu/finaid

Thank you for applying for financial assistance at UIW. Our office looks forward to partnering with you and providing options for funding your education at UIW. Your award letter provides important information concerning your eligibility, identifies programs you qualify for, and explains how to complete your file with our office.

2017-2018 Notification of Awards Example:

Red Cardinal
4301 Broadway
San Antonio, TX 78209

Student ID: W00000000
Date: November 02, 2016
Student Copy- For Your Records

Student ID: used for identification purposes at UIW

Dear Red,

UIW is pleased to offer the following resources based upon your anticipated enrollment, academic progress, and demonstrated need. Your **demonstrated need** of $39,953 is calculated by subtracting your **expected family contribution** of $6,813 from your total **cost of attendance** of $46,766. Awards may adjust if enrollment changes during the 100% drop or if you withdraw. Federal loans and work-study require half-time enrollment (6 undergraduate, 4 graduate, or 3 PhD hours per semester), while most grants (other than Pell) and scholarships require full-time enrollment. **Visit http://www.uiw.edu/finaid for required forms and additional information.**

Displays your Cost of Attendance (COA) and Expected Family Contribution (EFC) from your FAFSA. Your COA is the maximum aid you can receive. Your billed charges, or Direct Costs, will be less.

2017-2018 AWARDS	SUMMER 2017	FALL 2017	SPRING 2018	TOTAL
Scholarship-Undergrad Academic		6,000.00	6,000.00	12,000.00
Grant-State TEG		1,650.00	1,650.00	3,300.00
Grant-UIW Funds		1,250.00	1,250.00	2,500.00
Work Program- Federal		1,250.00	1,250.00	2,500.00
Loan-Direct Sub Loan		1,750.00	1,750.00	3,500.00
Loan-Direct Unsub Loan		1,000.00	1,000.00	2,000.00
Loan-Direct Parent PLUS		10,483.00	10,483.00	20,966.00
Total Awards:		$23,383.00	$23,383.00	$46,766.00

This section describes aid you are currently eligible to receive. Visit our webpage for more information about each program: www.uiw.edu/finaid

Additional messages for Red Cardinal :
[] All notifications are sent to your UIW Email account: **rcardinal@uiwtx.edu**
[] Email finaid@uiwtx.edu to decline or reduce loans, otherwise full amounts will disburse
[] Submit the UIW Student Information Form
[] Submit the Basic Texas Residency Questionnaire
[] Sign your Direct Loan MPN at **http://www.studentloans.gov**
[] Submit Loan Counseling at **http://www.studentloans.gov**
[] Submit a PLUS Loan Request online at **www.studentloans.gov**
[] Submit the UIW Payment Authorization Form
[] A denied PLUS loan allows a student additional Direct Unsub Loan.
[] Academic Scholarship requires full-time Undergraduate enrollment.
[] TEG Grant renewal requires that you complete 24 hours per year with a 2.5 GPA

Cardinal Email: all official UIW correspondence is sent here. Messages about events, disbursements, bills, scholarships, missing information and deadlines are communicated here. Check it often!

Your Additional Messages: explains what else you need to complete for your file. Be sure to read this information carefully and respond accordingly!

A Note About Direct Costs vs. Cost of Attendance:

Your actual billed charges are called Direct Costs. These are charges you will see on your bill (like tuition, fees, and on campus housing). **Your award letter displays your Cost of Attendance (COA), which is your maximum budget.** The COA includes direct costs that are billed to you (like tuition and fees) along with indirect costs that are not billed to you (like personal expenses, transportation, and off campus housing).

For example, the COA on this example award letter is $46,766. That is the **maximum** aid for this year, and cannot be exceeded. However, full time tuition for the 2017-2018 academic year is $27,900 and fees are estimated at $2,090. If this student lives off campus, the Direct Costs (tuition and fees) are $29,990. If the student lived on campus, dorm and meal plan costs of $12,436 would be charged, changing the Direct Costs to $42,426. **Please visit with us on-line or in our office if you have any questions concerning your costs and aid!**

Important Next Steps & Reminders

- **Apply for Outside Scholarships**
  - We have many outside scholarship searches and links available online at *www.uiw.edu/finaid/scholarships.html*.

- **Accept Your Awards**
  - Be sure to read your award letter carefully, and complete any additional requirements necessary to finalize your aid award. The Office of Financial Assistance will notify you concerning outstanding requirements via Cardinal email, your award letter, or in a separate tracking letter. All required forms are available in our office, can be downloaded at *www.uiw.edu/finaid* under "Forms," or be accessed directly through your BannerWeb or MyWord accounts.
  - Keep in mind that your award letter is not your bill – your actual charges are typically less than the aid awarded.
  - Remember to notify us if you choose to reduce or decline any of the loans or other aid that has been offered.

- **Notify the OFA of any outside resources you are expecting, or of changes to anticipated housing/enrollment**
  - Financial aid awards may be adjusted if any reported FAFSA information changes, or if you receive outside resources (i.e. VA benefits, Resident Assistant waiver, Graduate Assistant, discounts, outside scholarships, waivers, employer-paid tuition, etc.). You must notify our office of any outside resources.

- **Check your Cardinal email**
  - Once your Cardinal email is activated, we will use this email for important reminders and notifications. **Remember to check your Cardinal email regularly!** Your email account will be set up once you have paid your confirmation fee.

- **Register for Courses**
  - Undergraduate students must enroll full-time (12+ credit hours) in main campus coursework to receive UIW Grants, UIW Scholarships, State grants and/or Federal grants (other than Pell).
  - Enroll at least half-time (6+ hours) in a degree-seeking program to receive federal loans, work-study or Pell grant (if eligible). All other funds require full-time enrollment (12+ hours).

- **Verify your billed charges**
  - Waive health insurance charge (if you are covered by other valid health insurance) at *www.sas-mn.com* starting July 1 each year. The waiver deadline is the last day for 100% refund each Fall (published in the academic calendar).
  - Add a parking pass if you will be parking on campus (charged annually.)
  - Add a laptop (Ordering from UIW is optional – please make sure that your aid will cover this charge, or that you will pay out of pocket before signing the letter of intent.)

- **Estimate any out of pocket expenses**
  - Compare your accepted awards to your bill to see if you need additional funding, or if you will have excess funds. Should you decide to borrow a student loan, we recommend borrowing only what you need to cover your tuition.

- **Set up a payment plan**
  - Students with a remaining balance (before or after loans) may choose to set up a payment plan online through the MyWord Portal by clicking on e-Payment Center, or at *http://www.uiw.edu/busoff/how2pay.htm*. Questions about payment plans may be addressed through the Business Office at (210) 829-6043.

- **Apply for Work-study positions**
  - Work-study is not a guaranteed fund – students must apply for and be hired for positions. To learn more about work-study and see a list of available positions, please visit *http://www.uiw.edu/finaid/wkpgeligibility.html*.

- **Accept your loans (optional)**
  - If you plan to accept student loans, remember to complete the Entrance Counseling and the Master Promissory Note (MPN) online at *www.studentloans.gov*.
  - Be sure to account for Stafford/PLUS loan origination fees when estimating your final totals. For example, the origination fee as of 10/1/2016 on Subsidized/Unsubsidized loans is 1.069%*. For a loan of $1750.00 per semester, this results in a fee of $19 (rounded) per semester, with a net loan disbursement of $1731.00 per semester. *Subject to legislative change.

- **Apply for additional funding (optional)**
  - Parents of dependent undergraduate students may apply for a Parent PLUS Loan online at *www.studentloans.gov* or via paper application (available in the Office of Financial Assistance.)
  - If your parent is denied for the Parent PLUS Loan, your Unsubsidized loan may be increased by $4000 (Freshmen/Sophomores) or $5000 (Juniors/Seniors) for the year.